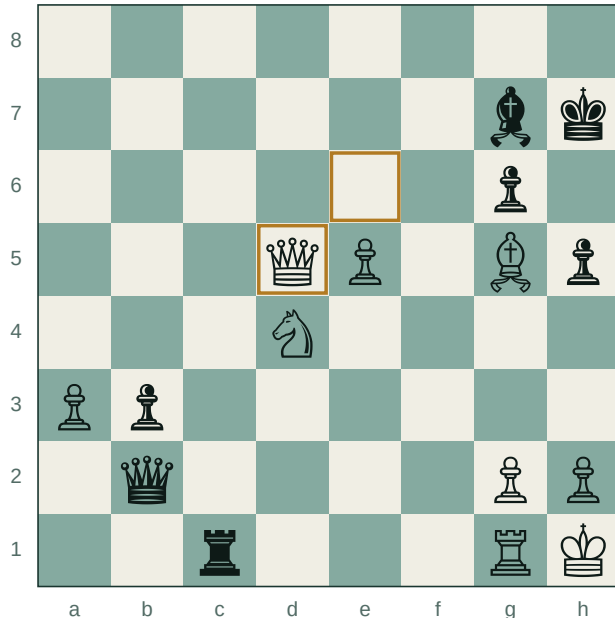


Attraction tactics: Black, move 40

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 40.Qxd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40...Rxc1+ 41. Kxc1 Qa1+ 42. Kf2 b2

40...Rxc1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on c1. Recorded reply: **41.Kxc1**.

41...Qa1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From a1 it attacks king on c1 and knight on d4. Recorded reply: **42.Kf2**.

42...b2 The pawn moves from b3 to b2.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -4 to -4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h1. Absolute pin: rook on g1.